

Order Expedite and Shipping Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy describes the three carriers that Northwind Traders uses, and states when an order may be expedited, what an expedite costs, and who must approve it. It was approved by Andrew Fuller, Vice President, Sales.

2. The three carriers

All orders ship from the Seattle warehouse with one of three carriers. The carrier is recorded on the order in the ShipVia field.

ShipVia	Carrier	Service level	Transit time	Chilled goods
1	Speedy Express	Express	1 to 3 days	Yes
2	United Package	Standard	3 to 5 days	Yes
3	Federal Shipping	Economy	7 to 10 days	No

Federal Shipping is the cheapest of the three carriers, United Package is in the middle, and Speedy Express is the most expensive. Federal Shipping is the default carrier for orders that contain only ambient goods. The customer may ask for a faster carrier when the order is taken. Orders that contain chilled goods are limited to the carriers allowed by the Perishables Handling and Carrier Guide (NW-POL-004).

3. What an expedite is

To expedite an order means to move it to Speedy Express so that it arrives sooner. If the order is already assigned to Speedy Express, the expedite gives it a priority pick in the warehouse on the same day.

4. When an order may be expedited

An order may be expedited only when all three of these conditions are true.

- 1 The order has not shipped. Its ShippedDate is empty.
- 2 The order is urgent. Its RequiredDate is no more than 5 calendar days after today, or its RequiredDate has already passed.

3 The order can ship complete. For every line, the units in stock are equal to or higher than the quantity ordered.

If condition 3 fails, the order is not expedited. The stock problem must be solved first, by reducing the line, by an approved substitute, or by waiting for stock.

For key accounts, the window in condition 2 is 10 calendar days instead of 5. In 2026 the key accounts are QUICK-Stop, Ernst Handel and Save-a-lot Markets.

5. What an expedite costs

The expedite surcharge is 40 percent of the freight amount recorded on the order. The surcharge is charged to the customer.

For key accounts, Northwind absorbs the surcharge and the customer is not charged.

6. Who must approve an expedite

The approval depends on the freight amount recorded on the order, in US dollars. It does not depend on the surcharge.

Recorded freight	Who may approve
Up to and including 50.00	The sales representative, on their own authority
Above 50.00, up to and including 250.00	The Sales Manager
Above 250.00	The Vice President, Sales

In this table, "sales representative" means the person recorded as the salesperson on the order, whatever their job title.

The same approval applies to key accounts, even though they are not charged.

Nobody may approve their own request. When the Sales Manager is the salesperson on the order, the request goes to the Vice President, Sales. When the Vice President, Sales is the salesperson, the request is countersigned by the Sales Manager.

Requests are sent to the Sales Approvals queue at sales-approvals@northwind.example. An expedite that is approved before 14:00 Seattle time ships on the same day. An expedite approved later ships on the next business day.

7. Overdue orders

An unshipped order whose RequiredDate has passed is overdue. The salesperson on the order must contact the customer within 1 business day, whether or not the order is expedited.

8. Carrier corrections are not expedites

Sometimes an unshipped order is assigned to a carrier that the Perishables Handling and Carrier Guide (NW-POL-004) does not allow for its goods. Logistics corrects the carrier at no charge to the customer, and no approval is needed.

If that correction already moves the order to Speedy Express, no expedite surcharge is charged, even when the order also meets the conditions in section 4. If the customer also asks for a same-day priority pick, that request is an expedite, and sections 4 to 6 apply to it.

9. What the AI assistant may do

The assistant may explain this policy, show the current order data, and say whether an order appears to meet the conditions in section 4. It may not approve, submit or carry out an expedite. Staff submit the request themselves through the Sales Approvals queue.